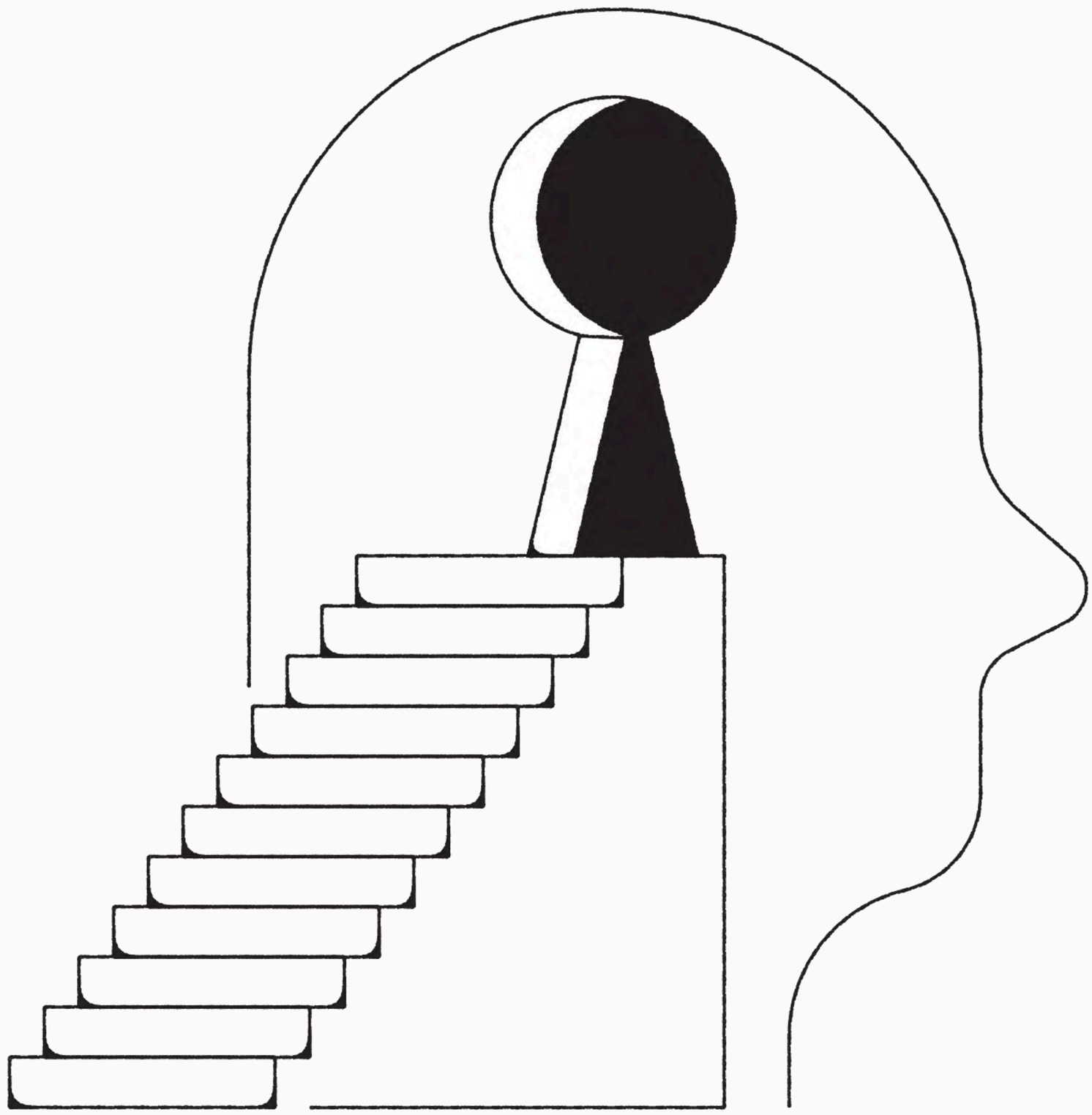


Beyond Belief: Unlocking the power of motivation

Welcome

When we look closely, we notice that beliefs drive our feelings — and how we act. Most of our limiting beliefs don't show up explicitly; they turn up quietly at the door like an uninvited guest.

They show up as delays and default thought patterns. Familiar enough that we don't question them. Familiar enough that we let them in.

We've all been caught up in those thought spirals:

- "I'll do it tomorrow."
- "I'm just not that kind of person."
- "There's no point applying."

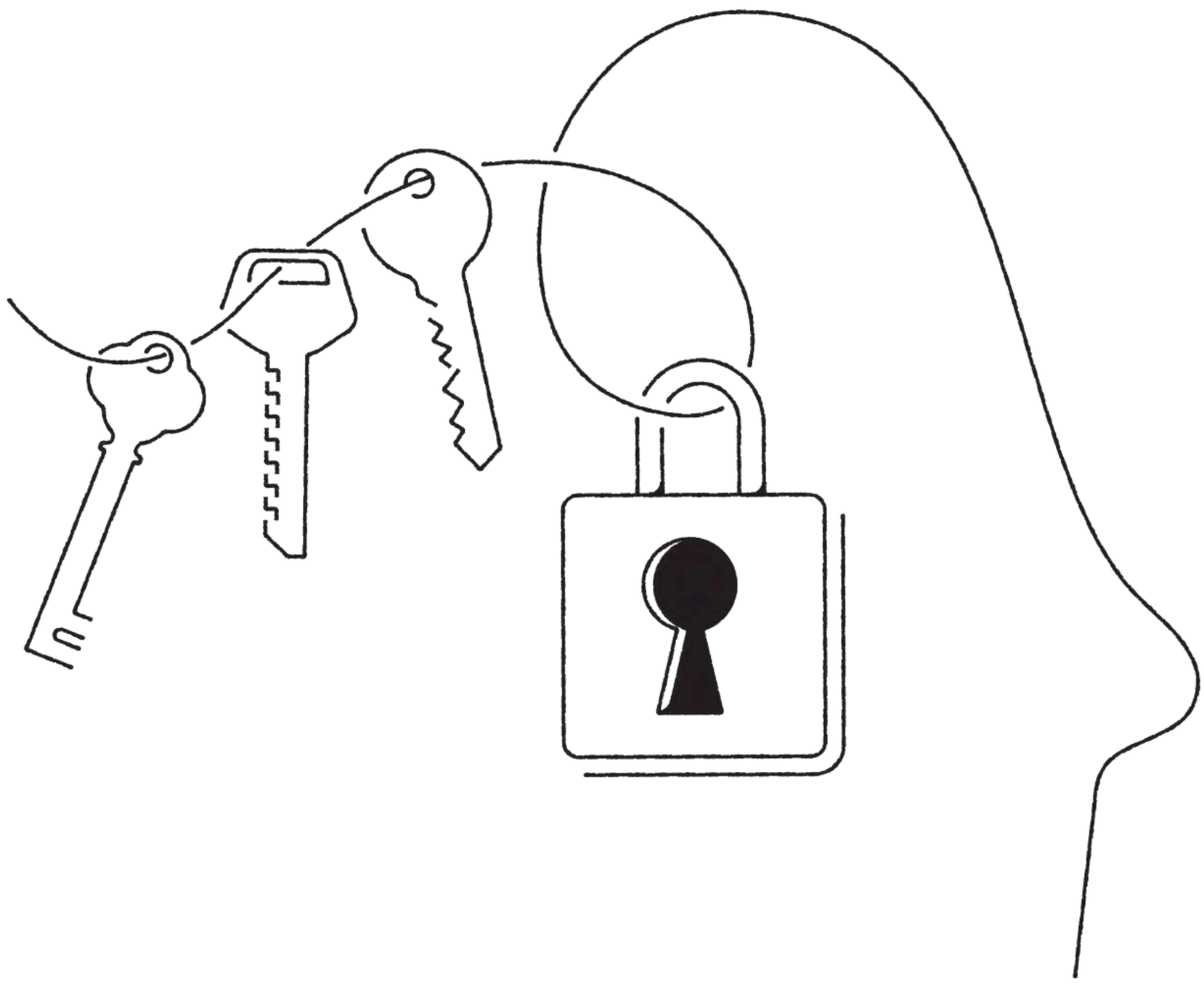
These beliefs can feel logical in the moment, but they're often the reason why we don't alter our behavior — and never get the benefits we say we want.

So what changes if we treat those thoughts as assumptions, not facts? If we challenge them, feel more motivated, and actually follow through on our ideas — making our beliefs work for us instead of against us?

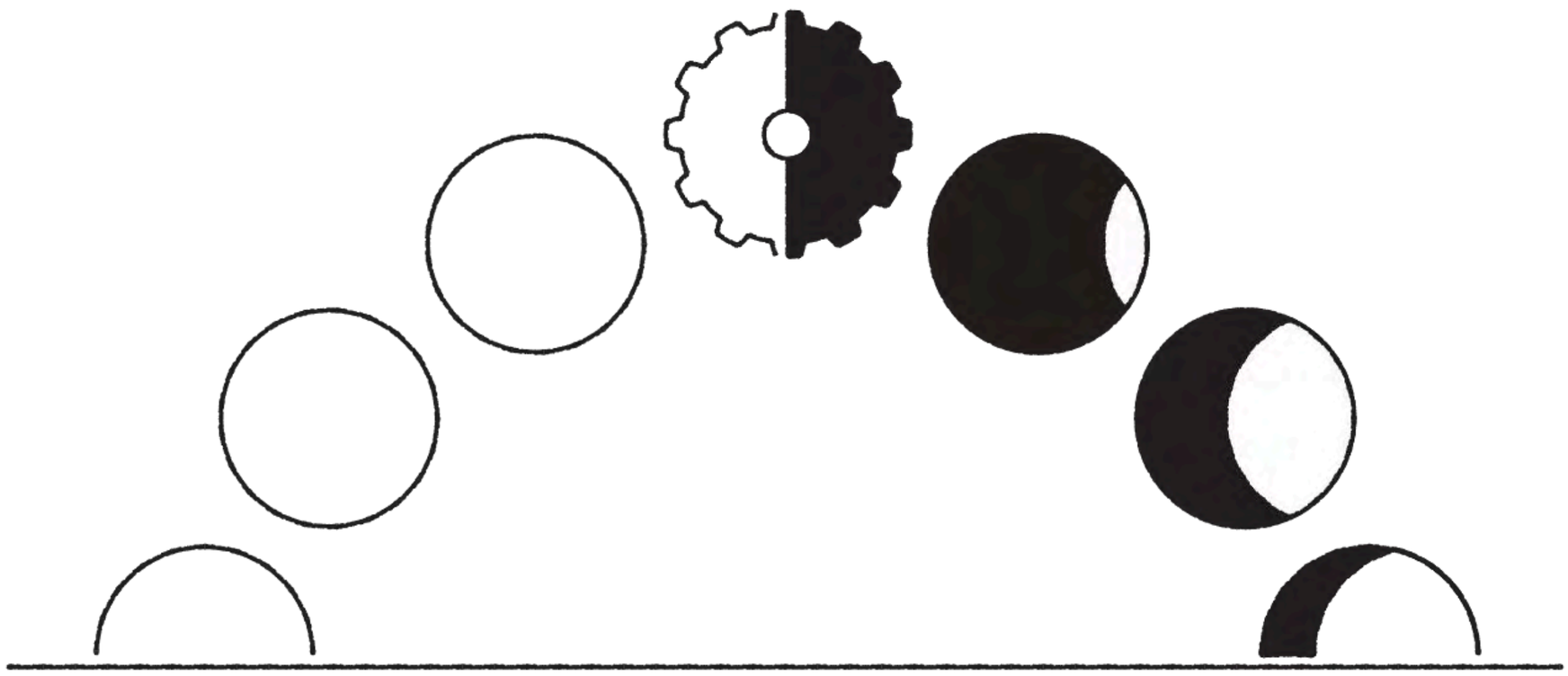
In his new book, *Beyond Belief: The Science-Backed Way to Stop Limiting Yourself and Achieve Extraordinary Results*, Nir Eyal argues that beliefs drive motivation. They shape what we notice (and what we filter out), what we expect, and — most importantly — whether we act.

That's why belief matters. It's the baseline that makes behavior stick.

> "Progress is impossible without change, and those who cannot change their minds cannot change anything."
>
> – George Bernard Shaw



The tools inside



This workbook has two short exercises: one for the morning, one for the evening. The aim is to help you move from a limiting belief to a more useful one. Not through “positive thinking”, but through something more grounded: small habits, honest reflection, and evidence you can trust.

Set some time aside. Open this workbook on your paper tablet. Use the exercises based on Nir Eyal’s frameworks.

Write the belief down. Seeing it on the page makes it easier to dissect – and harder to blindly obey. Treat your beliefs like tools, not truths.

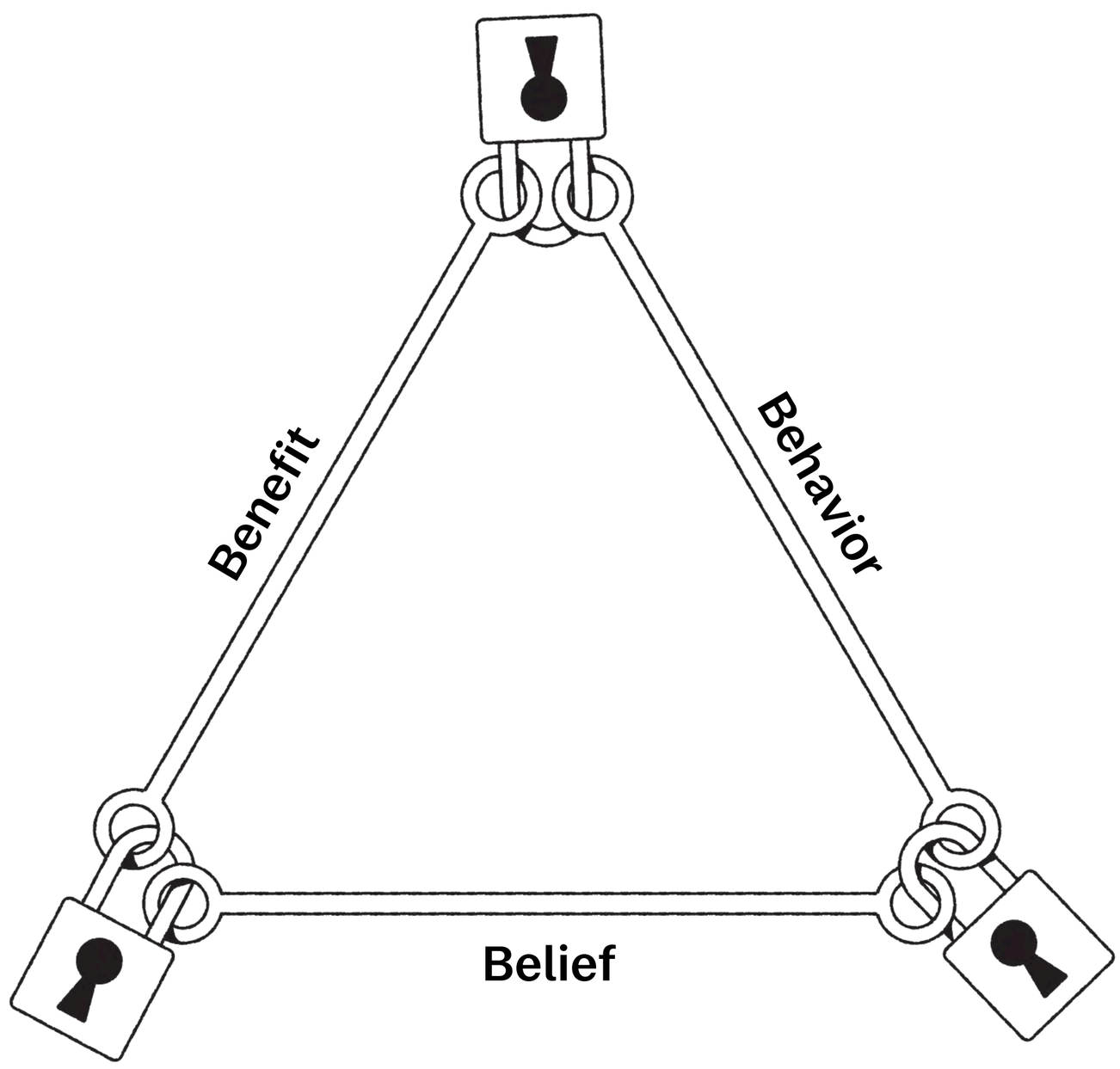
Notice them. Question them.
Test them out.

Then take the time to see what changes.

Exercises

Motivation tends to stick when you have three things: what you'll do (behavior), why it matters (benefit), and the idea that your effort will lead somewhere (belief).

Try applying the triangle to an everyday scenario where something hasn't worked out — or where you keep putting it off.



> "Without belief, our motivation collapses."
>
> – Nir Eyal

5-minute practice: day 1 **Date:**

Morning check-in

Yesterday's limiting belief:

What limiting belief showed up yesterday or might show up today?

I believe that ...

Today's liberating belief:

What happens if I flip the limiting belief into a liberating belief instead?

I could believe instead that ...

How strongly do I believe my limiting belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

How strongly do I believe this liberating belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

Today's intentions

◯ **See:** Today I choose to notice and find evidence for....

◯ **Feel:** Today I expect to feel...

◯ **Do:** Today I will take the following (small) action step....

5-minute practice: day 1

Evening check-in

Power	Intended	Actual
◯ See:		
◯ Feel:		
◯ Do:		

How strongly do I believe my limiting belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

Today's shift

1 2 3 4 5

How strongly do I believe this liberating belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

Today's shift

1 2 3 4 5

What created or didn't create today's shift?

5-minute practice: day 2 **Date:**

Morning check-in

Yesterday's limiting belief:

What limiting belief showed up yesterday or might show up today?

I believe that ...

Today's liberating belief:

What happens if I flip the limiting belief into a liberating belief instead?

I could believe instead that ...

How strongly do I believe my limiting belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

How strongly do I believe this liberating belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

Today's intentions

◯ **See:** Today I choose to notice and find evidence for....

◯ **Feel:** Today I expect to feel...

◯ **Do:** Today I will take the following (small) action step....

5-minute practice: day 2

Evening check-in

Power	Intended	Actual
◯ See:		
◯ Feel:		
◯ Do:		

How strongly do I believe my limiting belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

Today's shift

1 2 3 4 5

How strongly do I believe this liberating belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

Today's shift

1 2 3 4 5

What created or didn't create today's shift?

5-minute practice: day 3

Date:

Morning check-in

Yesterday's limiting belief:

What limiting belief showed up yesterday or might show up today?

I believe that ...

Today's liberating belief:

What happens if I flip the limiting belief into a liberating belief instead?

I could believe instead that ...

How strongly do I believe my limiting belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

How strongly do I believe this liberating belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

Today's intentions

◯ **See:** Today I choose to notice and find evidence for....

◯ **Feel:** Today I expect to feel...

◯ **Do:** Today I will take the following (small) action step....

5-minute practice: day 3

Evening check-in

Power	Intended	Actual
◯ See:		
◯ Feel:		
◯ Do:		

How strongly do I believe my limiting belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

Today's shift

1 2 3 4 5

How strongly do I believe this liberating belief right now?

1 2 3 4 5

Today's shift

1 2 3 4 5

What created or didn't create today's shift?

About

Nir Eyal

Nir Eyal is a writer, consultant, and teacher working at the intersection of psychology, technology, and human potential. He previously taught at Stanford Graduate School of Business, and his work has been used by organizations ranging from JPMorgan Chase to the US Air Force and PwC.

He's also the author of *Hooked* and *Indistractable*, which have sold more than one million copies in more than 30 languages. His writing has appeared widely in the press, including *The New York Times*, *Forbes* and *Psychology Today*. Eyal focuses on how people build habits, manage attention, and follow through on what matters.

In *Beyond Belief*, Nir Eyal and Julie Li argue that beliefs are not fixed truths — they're mental tools. When you choose better tools, you change what you notice, what you expect, and what you do.

https://www.nirandfar.com

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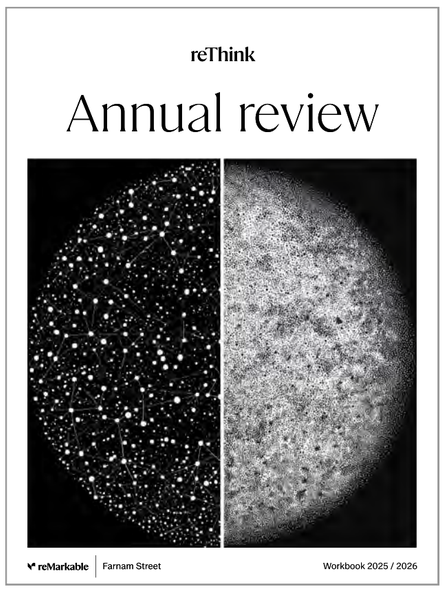

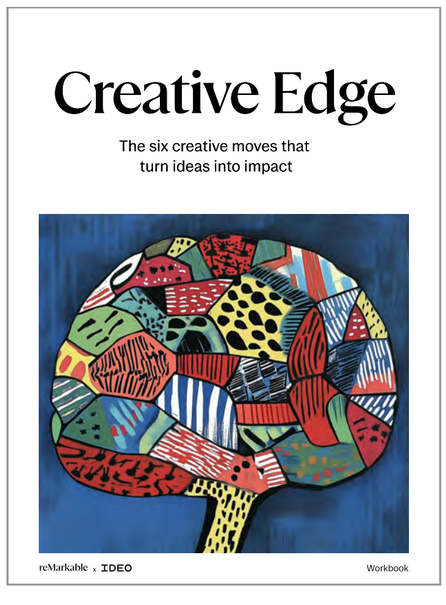

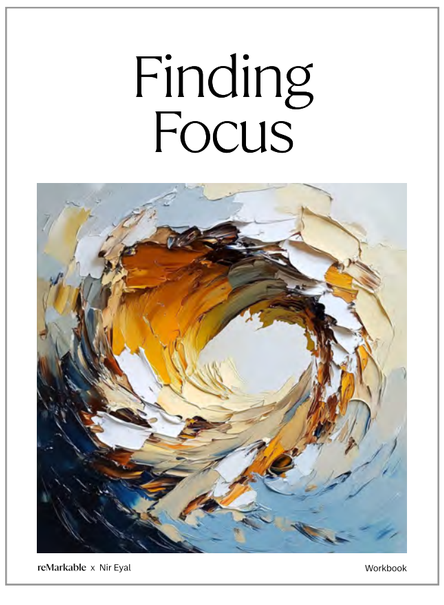

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Final thoughts

Give your feedback

We'd love to hear if and how this workbook has helped to increase your motivation. Scan the QR code below or visit the link for a quick two-minute survey.

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